

(600) Medical Coding

Description & Eligibility

This contest will assess the contestant's knowledge and skills in medical coding through theory and application questions using ICD-10-CM and CPT. Any postsecondary or secondary contestant may enter this application event.

Contestant Must Supply

- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials.
- Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See NLC Calculator Guidelines. Contestants who violate this rule will be disqualified. Contestants who violate this rule will be disqualified.
- Suggested resource: Manual ICD-10-CM (2024) and CPT (2024), only physical copies allowed no electronic references.

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: objective | application.
- No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for an event will be allowed in the testing area.
- No previous Business Professionals of America tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) may be taken into the testing area. Violation of this rule will result in disqualification.
- Length of event: no more than ten (10) minutes orientation, no more than ninety (60) minutes testing time, no more than ten (10) minutes wrap-up.
- Entries vary by state.

Contest Competencies

- Apply technical coding skills to a variety of medical diagnoses/conditions
- Demonstrate knowledge of coding guidelines
- Explain what code numbers are used in various healthcare settings
- Recognize the coding method by the number assigned
- Assign codes accurately using appropriate coding guidelines
- Accurately define coding terms, abbreviations, and symbols
- Determine coding sequence based on diagnoses provided